

Manohar Achar

 manoharachar.design  manohar.create@gmail.com  (313) 688-1048  linkedin.com/in/manohar-achar  Detroit, MI

Skills

Product Design: End-to-end UX, product thinking, information architecture, user flows, wireframes, prototyping, responsive UI, accessibility (WCAG)

Growth & Analytics: Funnel metrics, KPI definition, event taxonomy, instrumentation, GA4, Amplitude, Mixpanel

Research: Interviews, usability testing, surveys, synthesis, Qualtrics, Maze, UserTesting, Dovetail

Tools: Figma (libraries, Auto Layout, variables), FigJam, Jira, Adobe Creative Suite

Experience

Sparks Behavioral Services (cooperantlearning.com) | Product Designer

Bloomfield, MI

May 2025 - Jan 2026

- Led the 0-to-1 product design of Co-operant Learning, a CEU credentialing platform converting behavioral health podcast episodes into quiz-based learning experiences for BCBAs and RBTs, from concept through launch.
- Defined the end-to-end user journey across content discovery, registration, quiz completion, and certificate delivery, reducing ambiguity for a 3-person team and enabling launch in under 4 months.
- Instrumented a 2-week pilot (250 learners): 95 visits, 12 CTA clicks, 3 purchases, 2 completions; built an event taxonomy and KPI dashboard to pinpoint drop-offs.
- Raised task success from 60% to 80% and reduced time to certificate from 2:05 to 0:58 through usability testing and iteration.

University of Michigan-Dearborn | Graduate Research Assistant, UX Designer (Part-time)

Dearborn, MI

May 2025 - Present

- Designed a randomized Qualtrics study on L2 to L3 mode awareness using video scenarios (N=192; 81% completion; N=167 valid) and synthesized findings into decision-ready insights.
- Delivered 8 UX and HMI recommendations and improved mode-identification accuracy from 69% to 82% after iteration.

Ingersoll Rand Industrial Technologies | Senior Product Design Engineer

Bangalore, India

Jul 2023 - Jul 2024

- Led UX strategy for multi-brand platform support on the XS Series controller, adapting the interface for brand-specific variations across Ingersoll Rand and Gardner Denver product lines while maintaining a single codebase.
- Facilitated Agile ceremonies with cross-functional software engineering, defining sprint priorities and making scope trade-off decisions on requirements phasing.

Ingersoll Rand Industrial Technologies | Junior Product Design Engineer

Bangalore, India

Jul 2019 - Jul 2023

- Designed UI specifications for the XS Series controller across 3 display sizes (4.3", 7", 10"), defining layouts for home page tiles, alarms, diagnostics, settings, and trend views serving 15+ machine configurations.
- Designed the web-based remote monitoring interface mirroring the embedded controller dashboard, enabling technicians and plant managers to access real-time compressor data from any browser.
- Authored and maintained UI requirements within the SRS document (170+ pages, 44 revisions), translating 200+ functional requirements into implementable screen layouts and navigation flows.

Ingersoll Rand Industrial Technologies | Engineering Intern to Graduate Trainee

Bangalore, India

Jan 2018 - Jul 2019

- Mapped the information architecture of XS Series controller displays (4.3", 7", 10"), documenting how physical sensor data translated into on-screen views for operators; identified gaps in maintenance and trip state surfacing, proposing hierarchy improvements later adopted in the home page framework.

Selected Projects

Mochitta | 0-to-1 Product Design (Capstone)

Ann Arbor, MI

Aug 2025 - Present

- Designed an emotion-aware personal finance prototype; usability testing (n=8) achieved 93% task success and SUS 86. Pilot (n=30) reduced post-spend regret 28%.

Black Baza Coffee | Product Designer (Freelance)

Remote

Jun 2025 - Sep 2025

- Designed a commerce and community app; testing (n=12) raised impact info task success from 58% to 92%. Subscription intent improved from 3.6 to 5.7/7.

Education

MS Human-Centered Design and Engineering | University of Michigan-Dearborn | GPA: 3.8

Aug 2024 - Apr 2026

BS Mechanical Engineering | Nagarjuna College of Engineering and Technology | GPA: 3.7

May 2014 - May 2018

Awards & Community

Extra Mile Award, Ingersoll Rand (Feb 2024) | Outstanding Spot Award, Ingersoll Rand (Jun 2023)

Design Club at UMICH Dearborn | President | Grew participation 70% and delivered 12+ design assets for campus partners